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Intersectional Trauma-informed Recovery at a Recovery College

'Self-Recovery X4S Model'

The 4 substances by which a recovery college course content facilitates intersectional trauma-informed recovery are:

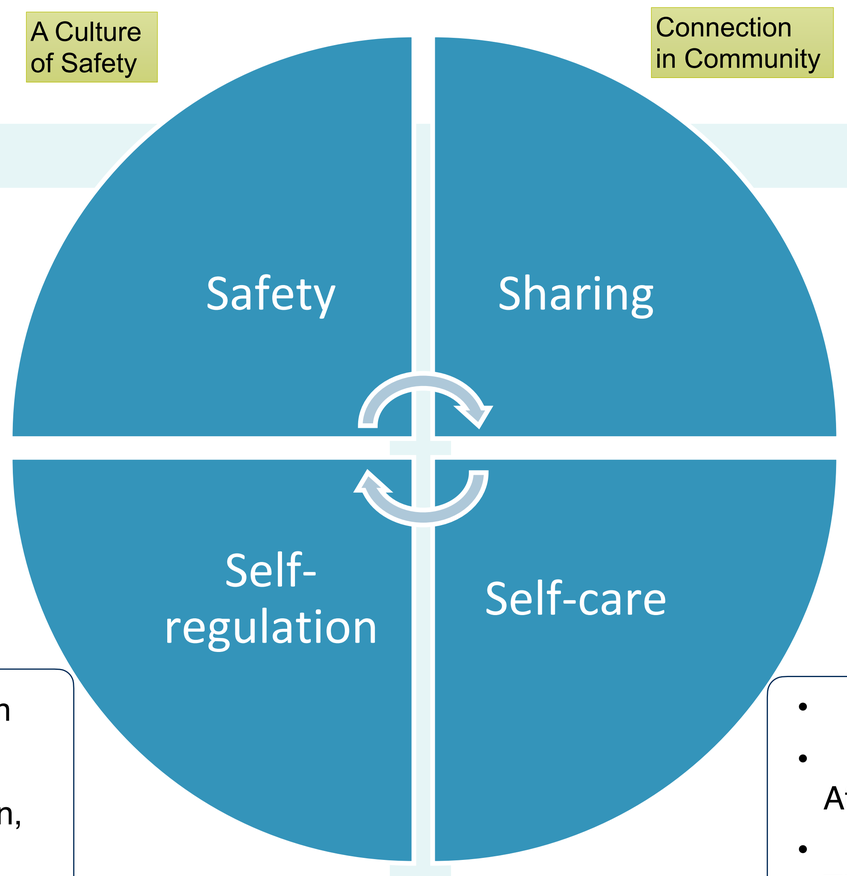
Safety, Sharing, Self-Regulation and Self-care.

(Miguel-Lorenzo, 2023)

- Group Agreement
- Student's & Tutor's Codes of Conduct
- Student's Charter
- Attendance Policy
- Enrolment Form
- Responding to Traumatic Disclosures Whilst Delivering a RC course
- Train the Trainer Co-production
- Safe Venues
- Safeguarding Pathway
- Signposting
- Pre-course and Follow Up Calls
- Recovery College Values
- ImROC and NHS Trust Policies

A Culture of Safety

Connection in Community



Being Present in the Body

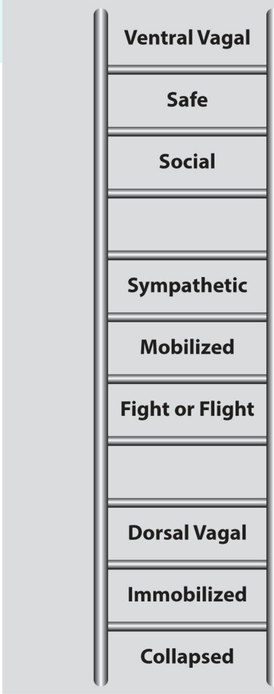
Being a Worthy Human Being

- Gender Responsive and Inclusive Classroom Co-production
- Nervous System Co-regulation
- Symptoms Psychoeducation
- Self-management Tools
- Experts by Profession and by Experience Co-production
- Peers-Lived Experience
- Intersectional Recovery Story Telling
- Self-discovery
- Social Skills
- Recovery Goals
- Hopes and Dreams
- Life Meaning and Purpose

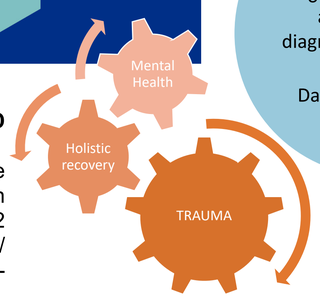
Polyvagal Theory Deb Dana (2018), Autonomic Ladder https://www.premayogainstitute.com/pyi-blog/polyvagal-theory-and-holistic-healthcare

- Nervous System Self-regulation
- Mindfulness and Breath Work
- Polyvagal Theory, Neuroception, Interoception, Autonomic Ladder
- Somatic Practices, e.g. Yoga
- Collaborative Practices
- Nature-based Activities
- Compassion-based Practices

- Body e.g. Bath, Rest, Exercise, Yoga
- Mind e.g. Meditation, Reading, Affirmations
- Emotional e.g. Music, Dancing, Therapy
- Social Relationships e.g. Friends, Family, Peers
- Spiritual e.g. Religious Groups, Spiritual Practices and Nature.



THE 10 PRINCIPLES OF RECOVERY, 2008, UK
Geoff Shepherd, Jed Boardman & Mike Slade (2008) Making Recovery a Reality. Sainsbury Centre for Mental Health.



THE 6 PRINCIPLES OF A TRAUMA-INFORMED PRACTICE, 2014 US; 2022 UK.
SAMHSA's Trauma and Justice Strategic Initiative July 2014; UK GOV. Guidance Working definition of trauma-informed practice. Published 2 November 2022. Image from: https://ppimhs.org/newspost/setting-new-standards-with-trauma-informed-care/

People in contact with the mental health system have experienced higher rates of interpersonal violence than the general population. Sweeney et.al.(2016)

Women face disproportionate rates of violence, homelessness, and unemployment
Daryn et. al. (2015)

Capital-T-trauma
Small-t- trauma
Maté & Maté (2022)

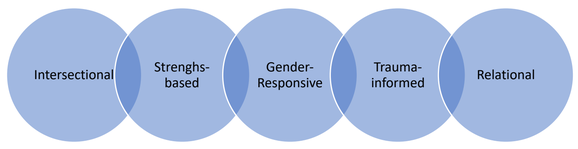
Mental Health is Trauma
Sweeney et.al.(2016)

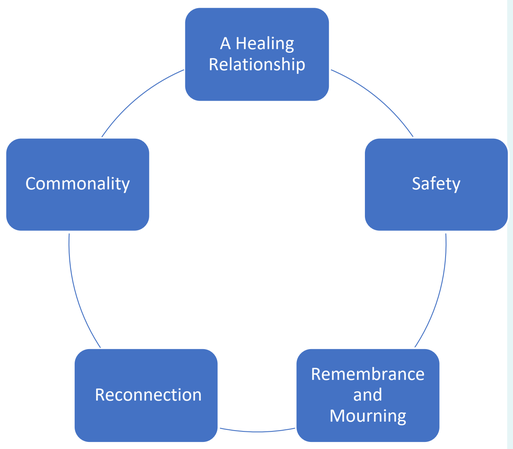
Women are overrepresented among people diagnosed with mental illness
Daryn et. al. (2015)

A Toxic Culture Is Trauma
Maté & Maté (2022)

Trauma causes disconnection from the self and the body
Maté & Maté (2022)

HER MODEL
HOLISTIC EMPOWERMENT RECOVERY MODEL
Dr. Akima Thomas.





THE 5 STAGES OF RECOVERY, 1992, US. Herman, Judith Lewis (2015 [1992]). Trauma and Recovery: The Aftermath of Violence. London: Pandora.

Intersectional Trauma-informed Recovery:
is a process by which a person (1) learns how traumatic events impact mental and physical health and how different levels of discrimination intersect and determine a person's capacity to minimise chances of becoming mentally unwell; (2) learns to feel safe among people, shares knowledge and works together with other people, understands who the person is in relation to others and re-discovers aspirations and a life purpose; (3) learns how to regulate her nervous system by herself or with others, to feel present, safe, and socially connected to other people; and (4) learns how to take care of her self at body, mind, emotional, social relationships, and spiritual level, to affirm the self and to cope with challenges. This process facilitates the recovery of the self and post-traumatic growth. Some people might fully recover others might be in a journey of on-going recovery throughout their lives (Miguel-Lorenzo, 2023).

References: Dana, Deb (2018) The Polyvagal Theory in Therapy. Engaging The Rhythm of Regulation. New York, London: W.W.Norton & Company; Daryn H. David, Michael Rowe, Martha Staeheli & Allison N. Ponce (2015) Safety, Trust, and Treatment: Mental Health Service Delivery for Women Who Are Homeless, Women & Therapy, 38:1-2, 114-127.; Geoff Shepherd, Jed Boardman & Mike Slade (2008) Making Recovery a Reality. Sainsbury Centre for Mental Health.; Herman, Judith Lewis (2015 [1992]). Trauma and Recovery: The Aftermath of Violence. London: Pandora; Maté, Gabor, & Maté, Daniel (2022) The Myth of Normal. Trauma, Illness & Healing In a Toxic Culture. London: Penguin Random House,; Slade M, Rennick-Egglestone S, Blackie L, Llewellyn-Beardsley J, Franklin D, Hui A, et al. (2019) Post-traumatic growth in mental health recovery: Qualitative study of narratives. BMJ Open. 9, pp.1-10.; Sweeney, Angela; Clement, Sarah; Filson, Beth; and Angela Kennedy (2016) Trauma-informed mental health care in the UK: what is it and how can we further its development?.Mental Health Review Journal, 21:3, pp.174-192